

Service Transition



Service Transition

- The service transition lifecycle stage is concerned with the delivery of a new or changed service into the live operational environment
- The service transition processes are used throughout the life cycle to provide control over the live operational environment
- Change management is used both to deliver new services and to modify them later and so provides control over the infrastructure
- The service transition process of service asset and configuration management provides a source of information which is used in transition, and the rest of the life cycle
- Knowledge management is particularly important during transition, but also takes place throughout the life cycle



The Purpose of Service Transition

- Each stage of the lifecycle has a distinct purpose, and the purpose of service transition is to ensure that the services that have been agreed on and designed through the stages of strategy and design are now delivered effectively into operation
- Any new, modified, or retired service should be transitioned in accordance with the plans and documents that have been prepared to meet the expectations of the business
- This is true if the service has been designed by the internal service provider or sourced from outside the organization
- The efforts that have been made during the previous lifecycle stages—negotiating with customers to understand their needs and requirements and the agreements that have been put in place—all need to be considered when introducing a new service or a change to an existing service
- It is in this stage that we are setting the expectation of the business, because this is the stage where we will test the new service for its ability to perform as required



The Purpose of Service Transition

- Think about this in terms of a project or implementation in which you have had some involvement
- What were the things that went well during the handover to operational staff?
- What went badly and caused issues in support or customer experience?
- It is during transition that we address these issues and put in place measurable, repeatable activities that will enable a smooth handover into operations
- Transition is an important lifecycle stage, because it ensures that the business receives the services as agreed and that they can be used as intended
- Ensuring the proper use of services is critical in achieving customer satisfaction; if your customer does not understand how the service is intended to work, they may find fault with something that it was never intended to perform



The Objectives of Service Transition

- Plan and manage changes to services, the introduction of new services, or the retirement of services efficiently and effectively
- Manage risk associated with new, modified, or retired services being transitioned
- Successfully deploy releases into the live environment
- Set the expectations for the performance and use of the new or modified services
- Ensure that the changes to the services deliver the anticipated and required business value
- Provide relevant and good-quality knowledge and information about the services and service assets



The Scope of Service Transition

- The service transition stage provides guidance on the development and improvement of the capabilities required to deliver new services into the live environment
- This covers the planning, build, test, evaluation, implementation, and deployment of new services or changes to existing services
- It also provides information and guidance on the transition of services between service providers (internal and external) and the retirement of services that are no longer required
- The guidance covers the relationship between strategy, design, and transition so that the requirements from service strategy, which are then developed in service design, may be successfully realized for operational use, while minimizing the risk and disruption of making changes
- The service transition lifecycle stage provides guidance on management and how transitions should work between all types of service providers, no matter what the situation
- This includes introducing new technologies, working with suppliers and partners, and managing working practices
- So, the scope of service transition covers all aspects of introducing new services to the operational environment. It will have a close association with project management activity and may adopt a project management approach to the coordination of the activities



Change Management



The Purpose of the Change Management Process

- ITIL states that the purpose of this process is “to control the lifecycle of all changes, enabling beneficial changes to be made with minimum disruption to IT services.”
- This simple statement cuts right to the heart of successful change management for an IT department
- If, in an organization that has not adopted best practices, you review your records for incidents following a change to your infrastructure, it is very likely that there will be an increase in incident volume specifically associated to the change that has been made
- Uncontrolled change may trigger or be the cause of incidents in the infrastructure
- According to the IT Service Management Forum (ITSMF), 80 percent of all incidents are caused by changes to the IT infrastructure



Objectives of the Change Management Process

- The objectives of the process reflect some of the issues identified in the previous section on its purpose
- A key objective is to keep abreast of the changes that happen in the business environment
- This objective specifically states that while responding to the changing business needs, you should be reducing incidents, disruption to the services, and rework
- In this way, the process can assist with maximizing the value of the IT services provided to the business
- It is an important objective to support your business, and as organizational needs evolve, the IT department or service provider should continue to ensure that the services align to business needs
- This will require the management of changes to the services to meet the challenges of a changing business
- The next objective identified by the ITIL Service Transition publication begins to show the process in action



Scope of Change Management

- The ITIL framework defines a change as “the addition, modification or removal of anything that could have an effect on IT services.”
- This means the scope of this process covers everything from the architecture and infrastructure to the processes, documentation, metrics, and tools that support your services, as well as changes to IT services and configuration items
- Defining the changes that are out of scope is equally important for successful management of change
- Typically these will include changes that have a significantly wider impact than just the services themselves, such as changes to departmental structures, business policies, or operations
- These changes may have associated IT service changes, which would be managed through the change process, but the initial management would be through business and organizational change processes
- But at the other end of the scale, the minor operational changes that need to be done as part of day-to-day management of the infrastructure may also be excluded from the change management process
- Examples of these would be routine maintenance changes such as simple repairs to printers



Types of Change

- Many different types of change exist in operational environments
- A change is captured as a formal request for alteration of a configuration item
- There are a number of ways of handling this formal request; it could be a service call to the service desk, a completed request for change form, or even a project initiation document
- A request for change is commonly referred to as an RFC
- Types:
 - Standard Change
 - Emergency Change
 - Normal change



Knowledge Management



Knowledge management

- Knowledge management is a process that impacts the wider service lifecycle, not just service transition
- This process provides you with one of the key systems for service management, the service knowledge management system
- In this process, you will be considering the purpose, objectives, and scope of knowledge management, as well as the concepts of the Data-Information-Knowledge-Wisdom (DIKW) model and the SKMS



Objectives

- Improve the quality of decision making throughout the service lifecycle
- Ensure that staff members have an understanding of the value of their services
- Maintain a service knowledge management system (SMKS)
- Gather, store, analyze, share, use, and maintain knowledge, information, and data throughout the service provider organization



Deployment Management



Release and Deployment Management

- The role of release and deployment management in this lifecycle stage is to ensure the successful introduction of changes into the live environment, minimizing the unpredicted impact to the business
- To deliver releases into the live environment successfully, you need to have control over the release management activities, and in this process we cover the purpose, objectives, and scope of the process, as well as the concepts of the release policy and the four phases of release and deployment



The Purpose of the Release and Deployment Management Process

- Release and deployment management is an important part of managing your live environment
- The process ensures that the build, test, and deployment of the release is delivered with minimal adverse impact to the business
- One of the key purposes of the process is to ensure that this activity is planned, scheduled, and controlled in accordance with the needs of the organization
- This is one of the most visible processes of transition, because it is where the interaction of the IT department and the business community meets to engage with the new or changed services
- During release and deployment, you will carry out pilots and testing of new services in order to understand whether the service design can be realized effectively in operation
- Release and deployment management needs to deliver the new functionality required by the business, and it is important to ensure that the new or changed services do not negatively impact the existing services

